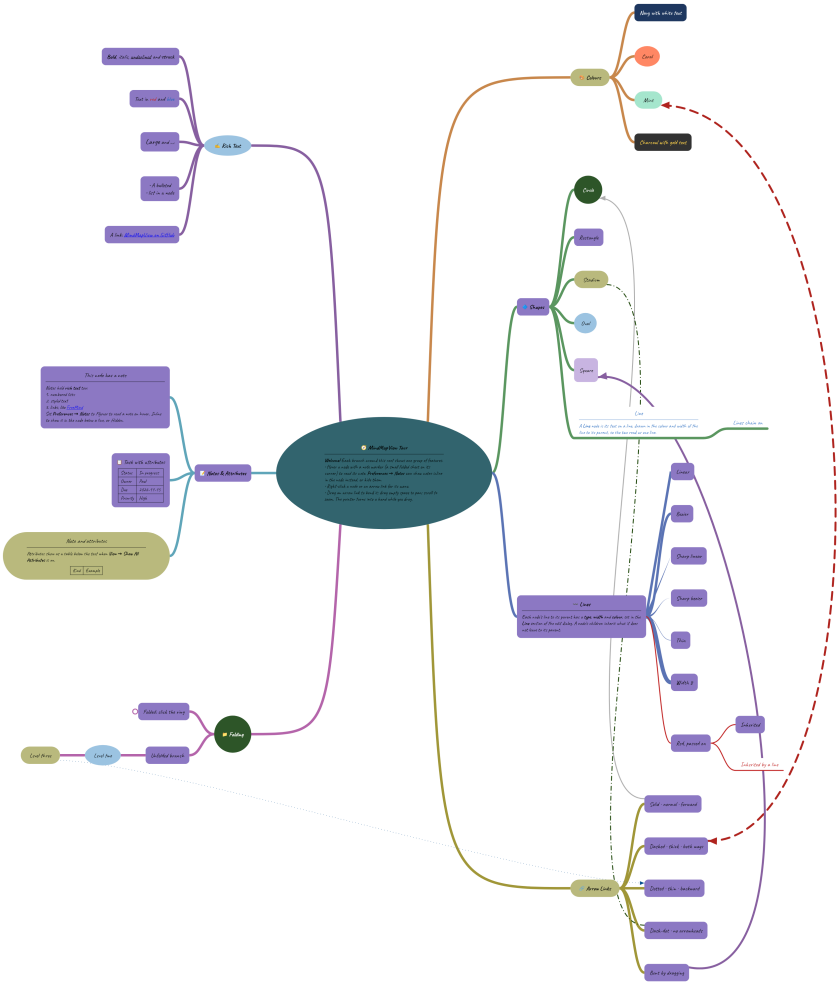
MindMapView

User Manual



Version 1.1.0 · for the desktop app and the web app

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1. Introduction

MindMapView is a mind map editor. A mind map starts from one central idea, the **root**, with related ideas branching out from it. Each idea is a **node**: a shape with text in it. You can give a node a note, attributes, links and an emoji, color it, fold its branch away, and draw arrows between any two nodes.

MindMapView runs in two ways that work the same:

- **The desktop app**, installed on your computer.
- **The web app**, in your browser at corbettcode.github.io/MindMapView, with nothing to install. Section 16 lists where it differs.

Maps are saved in MindMapView's own **.mmv** format, which keeps everything about a map. MindMapView also opens and exports **FreeMind (.mm)** maps.

> The map **feature_tour.mmv**, which comes with the source code, shows each feature of the app. Open it to explore while you read.

2. The window

The window has three parts:

- **The menu bar** along the top, with the **File**, **Edit**, **View**, **Tool** and **Help** menus. Each menu item that has a keyboard shortcut shows it on the right, and **Help › Keyboard Shortcuts** lists them all. The name of the map's file is in the middle of the menu bar, *Untitled* for a new map, with a ***** in front while it has changes that are not saved.
- **The find bar** below the menus, shown while you search the map (section 13).
- **The map**, which takes up the rest of the window.

A new map has only its root node, in the middle. The window's title shows the name of the file, and starts with an asterisk (*****) while the map has changes that are not saved.

The Help menu

- **User Manual (PDF)** opens this manual.
- **Keyboard Shortcuts** shows a table of all of the keyboard shortcuts.
- **README** shows the project's README, for developers using MindMapView as a library.
- **About** shows the app's version.

3. Adding, editing and removing nodes

Adding a node

A new node is always added as a child of the selected node. There are three ways to add one:

- Click the **+ button** on a node. It appears on the selected node and on the node under the mouse pointer, where the lines to its children start. The root has a + button on each of its six sides.
- Press `+` to add a child to the selected node.
- Choose **Edit › Add** and pick the shape of the new node: Circle, Rectangle, Stadium, Oval, Square or Line.

A node is named for its level in the map: the root is the **Root Topic**, a child of the root is a **Topic**, and a node below a topic is a **Subtopic**, however deep it is. Each way opens the **Add Topic** or **Add Subtopic** dialog, where you give the node its text and style. A new node starts with the text *Topic 1*, *Topic 2* and so on, or *Subtopic 1*, *Subtopic 2* and so on: topics and subtopics are each counted on their own. It takes the shape, colors and border of the last child of the node it is added to, so siblings look alike. The first child of a node gets the shape set in Preferences (section 16).

Click **Save & Close** to add the node, or **Add Another** to add it and open the dialog again for the next child of the same node, so you can add several in a row.

A **Line** node has no box: its text sits on a line, which carries on from the line to its parent in the same color and width. The lines to its children leave from the other end.

Editing a node

Double-click a node, choose **Edit › Edit**, or right-click the node and choose **Edit**. The **Edit Root Topic**, **Edit Topic** or **Edit Subtopic** dialog has these parts, from top to bottom:

Part	What it does
Shape	The node's shape, chosen from a drop-down list. The root is always an oval.
Emoji	An emoji shown in front of the node's text (section 6).
Text	The node's text, with a toolbar for bold, italic, lists, links and size.
Fill	The node's background color.
Text	The color of the node's text.
Border	What is drawn around the node, in a section that opens when the node has a border. Type is None or Line, Width is how thick the line is, and Color is its color. A border starts in the color of the node's text, but is its own color after that: changing the text color does not change it. New nodes have none.
Line	The **Type** (Linear, Bezier, Sharp linear or Sharp bezier), **Width** and **Color** of the line from the node's parent. Each can be left as *Inherited*, to take it from the parent; the node's children inherit it in turn. Click **Line** to open and close the section.
Note	A longer note (section 7). Click **Note** to open and close the section.

Attributes	Names and values (section 9), below the note. Click **Attributes** to open and close the section.

Press `Enter` or click **Save & Close** to keep your changes, or click **Cancel** to drop them. To put a line break in the node's text, press `Shift+Enter` or `Alt+Enter`. In the note, `Enter` starts a new line. The dialog can be resized; the note gets the extra room.

If you change the shape while the colors are still that shape's own, they change with it to the new shape's colors. Colors you chose yourself are kept.

Removing a node

Select the node and choose **Edit › Remove**, or right-click it and choose **Remove**. The nodes below it are removed too. MindMapView asks you to confirm first, unless you turned that off in Preferences. The root cannot be removed.

Undo and redo

`Ctrl+Z` undoes the last change and `Ctrl+Y` (or `Ctrl+Shift+Z`) redoes it. Adding, editing, removing, moving, pasting, folding and arrow links can all be undone. Selecting nodes, zooming and moving the view are not changes, so they are not undone.

4. Selecting and moving around

Selecting nodes

Action	Result
Click a node	Selects that node alone.
`Shift` + click	Selects the range of nodes from the selected node to the one clicked.
`Ctrl` + click	Adds the node to the selection and centers it, or takes it out of the selection.
`Ctrl+A`	Selects every node that is shown, apart from the root.
`Esc`	Clears the selection.

With several nodes selected, you can cut, copy or remove them together.

Moving the selection with the keyboard

Keys	Selects
`Ctrl+Left`	The parent of the selected node, towards the root.
`Ctrl+Right`	The first child of the selected node.
`Ctrl+Down`	The next child of the same parent.
`Ctrl+Up`	The previous child of the same parent.

Panning and zooming

- **Pan:** drag an empty part of the map.
- **Zoom:** turn the mouse wheel, or pinch on a touchpad.
- **View › Fit** zooms so the whole map fits in the window.
- **View › Center Selected Node** (`Ctrl+Alt+C`) moves the view so the selected node is in the middle. Right-click a node and choose **Center** to do the same for that node.

5. Arranging the map

The six sides of the root

The root's children can sit on six sides, evenly spaced around it: left, right, upper left, upper right, lower left and lower right. Each side has its own + button on the root. The nodes below a child of the root grow outwards to the left or right.

Each branch from the root is drawn in its own color, which the lines and + buttons further down that branch share.

Moving nodes

- **Re-attach a node:** drag it onto another node. It becomes a child of that node, and the nodes below it move with it.
- **Change a branch's side:** drag a node onto the root. It joins the side of the root nearest to where you drop it.
- **Move a branch around the root:** `Ctrl+M` moves the branch the selected node is in to the next side clockwise, and `Ctrl+Shift+M` counterclockwise. These are also in the **Edit** menu and a node's right-click menu.
- **Move the whole map:** drag the root. The rest of the map moves with it. A root you have not dragged stays in the middle of the window.

6. Formatting text and emojis

The text toolbar

The node's text and its note each have a toolbar. Select some text and click a button, or click a button and then type.

Button	Effect
B	Bold
I	Italic
U	Underline
~~S~~	Strikethrough

•	Bulleted list
1.	Numbered list
🔗	Add, change or remove a web link (section 8)
Size ▾	Small, Normal or Large text

The root topic, the topics and the subtopics each have a font, which you choose for each in Preferences: Default, Inter, Lora, Nunito, Caveat or JetBrains Mono. A node's note and attributes are in its font too.

Emojis

Click **Emoji** at the top of the edit dialog to open the emoji picker. You can:

- Browse by category, such as Smileys & Emotion, Animals & Nature or Flags.
- Type in **Search** to find an emoji by name.
- Pick from **In this map**, the emojis other nodes already use.
- Choose a skin tone for emojis that have one. The app remembers your choice.
- Choose **None** to take the emoji off the node.

The chosen emoji is shown in front of the node's text, at the same size as its first letters. The dialog previews it in front of the text as you type.

7. Notes

A note holds more than fits in a node: details, lists, links or pictures. How notes are shown is set by **Notes** for the root topic, the topics and the subtopics each in Preferences (section 16):

- **Flyover**, the first setting: a node with a note shows a small note icon at its corner. Rest the mouse on the note icon for a second to see the note in a pop-up.
- **Inline**: the note is shown in the node, below a line under the node's text, and the node grows to fit it. Pictures are not shown, and links in it cannot be clicked.
- **Hidden**: the note is not shown, but the node keeps its note icon.

Write the note in the **Note** box of the edit dialog, with the same text toolbar as the node's text.

Writing in Markdown

Click **MD** above the note to edit it as Markdown text instead, for example `**bold**`, `*italic*`, `- list item` or `[text](https://example.com)`. Click **MD** again to go back to formatted text.

Pictures

To put a picture from your computer in a note, click the picture button (🖼) in the note's toolbar and choose a PNG, JPEG, GIF, WebP or BMP file. The picture goes where the cursor is, and is saved in the map's .mmv file, so the original file is no longer needed. A note can also show a picture from the

web with Markdown like `![description](https://example.com/picture.png)`. The note's pop-up appears once its pictures have loaded.

8. Web links

Text in a node or a note can link to a web page or an email address. Select the text, click the 🔗 button in the toolbar, type the **Address** and click **OK**. To change or remove a link, put the cursor in it and click 🔗 again.

Only **http**, **https** and **mailto** addresses can be linked to. Since maps may come from other people, MindMapView never opens other kinds of links.

To open a link:

- Hold `Ctrl` and click it in the node, or
- Select the node and choose **Edit › Open Link**, which lists every link in its text and note.

A plain click on a link only selects the node, so clicking doesn't open web pages by mistake.

9. Attributes

Attributes are name-and-value pairs, such as *Status: In progress* or *Due: 2026-11-15*. How they are shown is set by **Attributes** for the root topic, the topics and the subtopics each in Preferences (section 16):

- **Inline**, the first setting: the attributes are drawn as a small table below the node's text, and the node grows to fit it.
- **Flyover**: a node with attributes shows a small table icon at its lower right corner, as a node with a note shows a note icon at its upper right. Rest the mouse on the icon to see the attributes in a pop-up.
- **Hidden**: the attributes are not shown, but the node keeps its table icon.

A map theme can choose how attributes are shown for its maps; the built-in themes all follow the preference.

- A node's attributes are edited in its edit dialog, in the **Attributes** section below the note. Click **Attributes** to open and close the section; it starts open when the node has attributes. Select a node and press `Alt+F9` or choose **Edit › Attributes…** to open its edit dialog with the section open. Attributes can also be given to a node as it is added.
- In the **Attributes** section, type a **Name** and **Value** on each row. Click **+ Add attribute** for a new row, or ✕ to delete one. `Enter` moves from a name to its value, and from a value to the name on the next row; on the last row it adds a new one. Elsewhere in the dialog, `Enter` saves and closes it.
- Buttons such as **+ Status** add a row named after an attribute that other nodes already have, to keep names the same across the map.

10. Folding

Folding a node hides the nodes below it, so a large map is easier to read. A folded node shows a small ring where its lines would start; click the ring to unfold it. The root cannot be folded.

The folding commands are in the **View** menu:

Command	Keys	Effect
Toggle Folded	`Space`	Folds or unfolds the selected node.
Toggle Children Folded	`Ctrl+Space`	Folds or unfolds each child of the selected node.
Fold One Level	`Alt+PageUp`	Hides the deepest level shown below the selected node.
Unfold One Level	`Alt+PageDown`	Shows one more level below the selected node.
Fold All	`Alt+Home`	Folds everything below the selected node.
Unfold All	`Alt+End`	Unfolds everything below the selected node.

A node with children also has **Fold** or **Unfold** in its right-click menu. Folds are saved with the map, including in FreeMind files.

11. Arrow links

An arrow link is a curved arrow from one node to any other node, drawn on top of the map. Use it to show a connection that isn't parent and child.

Adding an arrow link

- Select the node the arrow starts from and press `Ctrl+L`, choose **Edit › Add Arrow Link**, or right-click it and choose **Link**. Then click the node the arrow should point to. Press `Esc` to cancel.
- Or hold `Ctrl` and drag one node onto another. Doing this again between the same two nodes removes the arrow.

Changing an arrow link

Drag an arrow to bend its curve. **Right-click** an arrow for its menu:

Item	Effect
Go to: ...	Selects and shows the node at either end of the arrow.
Arrowheads	Forward, Backward, Both Ways or No Arrowheads.
Line style	Solid, Dashed, Dotted or Dash-Dot.
Thickness	Thin, Normal or Thick.
Color	The arrow's color.
Reset Curve	Undoes any bending, back to the arrow's own curve.
Remove Arrow Link	Removes the arrow.

12. Cut, copy and paste

- `Ctrl+C` copies the selected nodes, with all the nodes below them.
- `Ctrl+X` cuts them. Cut nodes can be pasted back, so they are removed without asking.
- `Ctrl+V` pastes them as children of the selected node.

These are also in the **Edit** menu and a node's right-click menu. Pasting within MindMapView keeps everything about the nodes: shapes, colors, notes, attributes and folds.

Working with other programs

Copied nodes also go on the clipboard as an indented outline of plain text, one line per node. You can paste that into a text editor, email or document.

Going the other way, you can paste text copied from another program. Each line that isn't blank becomes a node. A line indented more than the line above it becomes that line's child. Bullets such as **-**, ***** or • at the start of a line are left out. For example:

```
Holiday
    Travel
        Book flights
        Rent a car
    Packing
```

The new nodes look like the last child of the node you paste into.

13. Finding nodes

Press `Ctrl+F` or choose **Edit › Find...** to open the find bar, then type. MindMapView selects the first node whose text or note contains what you typed, ignoring capital letters. The bar shows which match you are on and how many there are.

- ▼ or `F3` goes to the next match.
- ▲ or `Shift+F3` goes to the previous match.
- × closes the find bar. `F3` still finds the same text again afterwards.

Nodes hidden inside folded nodes are found too: their branch is unfolded to show them. Matches are found from the selected node onwards, so clicking a node and pressing `F3` carries on from there.

14. Files: open, save, import and export

The File menu

Item	Keys	Effect

New	`Ctrl+N`	Starts an empty map.
Open...	`Ctrl+O`	Opens a MindMapView (.mmv) or FreeMind (.mm) map.
Recent		Lists the maps opened or saved most recently.
Save	`Ctrl+S`	Saves the map to its file.
Save As...	`Ctrl+Shift+S`	Saves the map to a new file.
Export		Writes the map in another format (see below).

`Alt+F` opens the File menu.

Saving

Maps are always saved as **.mmv** files. The first time you save a new map, MindMapView suggests a file name based on the root's text. A FreeMind map you opened is saved as a .mmv file next to the original, leaving the original as it was.

The images in a map's notes are saved in the .mmv file with it, so the map shows them even when the web pages they came from are gone or you are offline. An image that cannot be loaded when the map is saved keeps only its web address.

If you start a new map, open another, or close the app while the map has unsaved changes, MindMapView asks whether to **Save**, **Don't Save** or **Cancel**.

Recent maps

When two recent maps have the same name, their folders are shown to tell them apart. If a recent map has been moved or deleted, MindMapView offers to remove it from the list.

Importing

Tool › Import replaces the nodes of the open map with those read from another file, but keeps the open map's file name. The next save writes the imported nodes to that file. MindMapView asks you to confirm first, unless the map has only its root. Import can be undone.

Item	Reads
Map...	A MindMapView (.mmv) or FreeMind (.mm) map.
Markdown (md)...	A Markdown document, as a map of its headings and lists (see below).
XMind (xmind)...	An XMind map, from XMind 8 or a later XMind (see below).
Folder...	A folder on your computer, as a map of the folders in it (desktop app only; see below).

From a folder, the root is the folder you chose, with its full path as its note, and each folder inside it becomes a node under the folder it is in. Files, hidden folders and links to folders are left out. Folders more than two levels down start folded, so the map opens small. A map holds at most 1,000 folders: past that, the deepest ones are left out, and the root's note says so.

From a Markdown document, each heading and each list item becomes a node. A heading holds the lower headings after it and the lists under it, and a list item holds the items indented under it. Other text becomes the note of the heading or item it follows. When the document has a single top heading, that heading is the root; otherwise the root is named after the file, and any text before the first heading is its note. Bold, italic, struck-through text and links are kept, and task list boxes are shown as ☐ and ☑.

A paragraph that starts with bold text, such as **Event sourcing.** Every record is its own event stream..., becomes a node of its own: the bold text is its text, and the rest of the paragraph its note.

A table becomes a branch of the heading or list item above it, named after the header of its first column. Each row becomes a node under that branch, named after its first cell, and the other cells become that node's attributes, named after their column headers (see Attributes). When the first header is empty, the rows go straight under the heading.

From an XMind map, each topic becomes a node, and its notes become the node's note. A topic's own subtopics come first among its children, followed by its floating topics, summaries and callouts. When the map has one sheet, its central topic is the root; when it has several, the root is named after the file, and each sheet's central topic is a branch of it. Markers become emojis in front of the text, such as 1️⃣ for priority 1 and ✅ for a finished task. Labels become a Labels attribute, a web link makes the topic's text a link, and relationships become arrow links. Fill and text colors, bold and italic text, the shapes MindMapView has, and folded branches are kept; images, boundaries and the map's theme are not. A password-protected map cannot be imported.

Exporting

Format	What you get
As Image (PNG)...	A picture of the whole map in its theme, including parts that are off screen. Folded branches stay hidden.
As HTML Outline...	A web page of nested lists, with notes and attributes. Branches can be folded in the browser, and start folded where they are in the map.
As FreeMind Map (.mm)...	A map for FreeMind and the programs that read its format. FreeMind only has left and right sides, so nodes on the upper and lower sides go to the left or right.
As SVG Drawing...	The same picture as the PNG, as a drawing that stays sharp at any size. Its text can be searched and selected. Browsers and drawing programs open it; on a computer without the map's fonts, they show the text in a font of their own.
As PDF Document...	The same drawing on one page the size of the map, with its fonts in the file, so it looks the same everywhere and its text can be searched. A very large map is made smaller to fit the largest page PDF viewers show. Color emoji are left blank. The first PDF takes a few seconds, while the app looks through the computer's fonts. Not in the web app: export the SVG drawing and print it to a PDF from the browser instead.
As OPML Outline...	An outline for outliners such as Workflowy, OmniOutliner and Logseq, with every node, the text without its formatting, notes as plain text and attributes.

As Markdown...	A Markdown document that Tool › Import › Markdown reads back as the same map: the top three levels as headings, the nodes below them as lists, notes as paragraphs, and bold, italic, struck-through text and links. Nodes with attributes and no children are written as rows of a table, so they come back first among their siblings and without their notes, and the attributes of a node with children are left out. Shapes, colors, lines, arrow links and folds are left out.

Exporting doesn't save the map: unsaved changes stay unsaved.

15. Map themes

A theme gives the whole map a look in one step: its background, the colors of the root, the main topics (the nodes next to the root) and the nodes below them, the colors and width of the lines, borders, and the font. Open **Preferences**, choose a theme under Map theme and click OK: the open map takes it, as a change Undo can take back along with the preferences the theme set, and new maps start in it from then on. The theme is saved in the map's file, so the map looks the same to anyone who opens it, and a map you open keeps its own theme.

The themes are Classic (the look maps have always had), Ocean, Night, Paper, Meadow and High Contrast.

A theme only changes what you haven't changed yourself. A node whose fill, text color, border or line you chose keeps it in every theme. In the edit dialog, the first color of the Fill and Text rows is the one that follows the theme: choose it to give a node back to the theme.

The window follows the map's background: it is dark around a map in the Night or High Contrast theme, and light around the others. Exported images, SVG drawings and PDFs are drawn in the map's theme too.

16. Preferences

Choose **Edit › Preferences...** or press `Ctrl+,` to change:

Setting	Choices
Map theme	The look of the open map and of new maps (see Map themes). It opens on the open map's theme; choosing another changes that map and the theme new maps start in, and replaces the settings below that the theme has with its own.
Background color	The color the map is drawn on. **Reset** goes back to the theme's background.
Root Topic, Topic, Subtopic	How each kind of node is drawn and added (see below).
Arrow link colors	The colors offered in an arrow link's menu. A new arrow link starts in the first of them.
Ask before removing a node	Whether removing a node asks you to confirm.

The color settings and each kind of node have a section of their own. Click its title to open or close it.

Root Topic, Topic and Subtopic

The root is the **Root Topic**, its children are **Topics**, and every node below them is a **Subtopic**. Each of the three has:

Setting	What it does
Text font	Default, Inter, Lora, Nunito, Caveat or JetBrains Mono, for the text of nodes of this kind.
Notes	Flyover, Inline or Hidden: how the note of a node of this kind is shown (section 7), unless the node has a way of its own.
Attributes	Inline, Flyover or Hidden: how the attributes of a node of this kind are shown (section 9), unless the node has a way of its own.
Shape	The shape a node of this kind is added in, when it is the first child of its parent. Later children copy their last sibling. The root is always an oval, so the Root Topic has no shape.
Fill and Text	The colors nodes of this kind are drawn in, unless a node has been given colors of its own. The empty circle leaves each node in the color of its shape, as the Classic theme does. The other circles are the colors offered in the edit dialog for a node of this kind.
Border	The border nodes of this kind are drawn with, unless a node has a border of its own.

Click a color in the Fill or Text row, then change it with the color picker or type its **Hex** code. **Add** puts the color among those offered in the edit dialog, and **Remove** takes it out. **Reset** goes back to the map theme's settings for that kind of node. The Arrow link colors work the same way.

Click **Save & Close** to keep your changes, or **Cancel** to drop them.

A map is saved with the preferences of how it looks: the background, the three kinds of node with their fonts, the arrow link colors and how notes and attributes are shown. Opening a map brings them back. A map saved by an earlier version takes those of its theme. Whether to ask before removing a node is yours alone, for every map.

17. The web app

The web app at corbettcode.github.io/MindMapView is the same app, running in your browser. It needs a recent browser: Chrome or Edge 119, Firefox 120, Safari 18.2 or later. It differs from the desktop app in these ways:

- In Chrome and Edge, **Save** writes back to the file you opened. Other browsers download the map instead.
- In Chrome and Edge, the **Recent** menu lists maps by name only, as a web page isn't told which folder a file is in. The browser asks you to allow the file again before opening it. Other browsers have no Recent menu.
- Pasting text from other programs asks for the browser's permission first.
- Pictures in notes only show when the website they come from allows it.

- Preferences are kept in the browser, so each browser has its own.
- Some shortcuts, such as `Ctrl+N`, belong to the browser. Use the menus for those.
- The browser warns you before you leave the page with unsaved changes.

18. Keyboard shortcuts

Files

Keys	Command
`Ctrl+N`	New map
`Ctrl+O`	Open a map
`Ctrl+S`	Save
`Ctrl+Shift+S`	Save As
`Alt+F`	Open the File menu

Editing

Keys	Command
`+`	Add a child to the selected node
`Enter`	Edit the selected node
`Ctrl+Z`	Undo
`Ctrl+Y`, `Ctrl+Shift+Z`	Redo
`Ctrl+X`	Cut
`Ctrl+C`	Copy
`Ctrl+V`	Paste
`Alt+F9`	Edit attributes
`Ctrl+L`	Add an arrow link from the selected node
`Ctrl+M`	Move the branch clockwise around the root
`Ctrl+Shift+M`	Move the branch counterclockwise around the root
`Ctrl+,`	Open the Preferences

In the edit dialog

Keys	Command
`Enter`	Save & Close (in the note: a new line)
`Shift+Enter` or `Alt+Enter`	A new line in the node's text

Selecting and finding

Keys	Command
Arrow keys	Select the nearest node that way
`Ctrl+A`	Select all nodes
`Esc`	Clear the selection, or cancel adding an arrow link
`Ctrl+Left`	Select the parent
`Ctrl+Right`	Select the first child
`Ctrl+Down` / `Ctrl+Up`	Select the next / previous sibling
`Ctrl+F`	Find
`F3` / `Shift+F3`	Find next / previous

View and folding

Keys	Command
`Ctrl+Alt+C`	Center the selected node
`Space`	Fold or unfold the selected node
`Ctrl+Space`	Fold or unfold its children
`Alt+PageUp` / `Alt+PageDown`	Fold / unfold one level
`Alt+Home` / `Alt+End`	Fold / unfold all

Mouse

Action	Result
Double-click a node	Edit it
Right-click a node	Its menu
Right-click an arrow link	Its menu
Drag a node onto another	Re-attach it
`Ctrl` + drag a node onto another	Add or remove an arrow link
Drag an arrow link	Bend it
Drag the root	Move the whole map
Drag empty space	Pan
Mouse wheel / pinch	Zoom
`Ctrl` + click a link	Open it
Click a fold ring	Unfold the node

The mouse pointer turns into a hand over an arrow link, and while you drag a node, an arrow link or the map.

19. Open source licenses

MindMapView is open source software under the MIT License. Its source code is at github.com/corbettcode/MindMapView.

```
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